DEVS CREATE 313

BUILDING WITH CLAUDE

Research and Test

A fill-in-the-blank workbook for checking your app against the market and real people

What you will leave with

☐ A Competitor Analysis PDF that compares your app to 5 real apps in the store

☐ A printable Usability Test Plan PDF with tasks, questions, and a blank Feedback Log

How to use this workbook

Each stage has a starter prompt. Copy it into Claude and replace anything in **[BRACKETS]** with your own details. If a bracket lists choices separated by slashes, keep the one that fits and delete the rest.

Keep working in the same project folder you used for your idea, spec, and prototype. Both prompts read files from that folder: the Competitor Analysis can use your spec, and the Test Plan reads your HTML mock app.

What you need before you start

Stage	Have this ready	You get
1. Competitor analysis	A 3–5 sentence app description or your spec PDF, the store you want to research, and your pricing plan	Landscape PDF with a 5-app table and sources
2. Usability test plan	Your clickable HTML mock app in the project folder, and a description of who will test it	2-page printable plan plus a Feedback Log page

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STAGE 1 | RESEARCH

Competitor Analysis

See which apps already solve this problem, what they charge, and what their users complain about.

STEP 1: COMPETITOR ANALYSIS (ATTACH YOUR SPEC PDF IF YOU HAVE ONE)

I'm planning an app and need a competitor analysis as a PDF that a complete beginner can understand.

MY APP

[Paste a 3–5 sentence description, or attach the spec and say "read the attached spec first."]

Store to research: **[Apple App Store (US) / Google Play (US) / both]**

Pricing model I'm planning: **[free, subscription, one-time unlock, ads, undecided]**

COMPETITORS

Find 5 real apps that compete with my idea. Search the web for current information. Don't rely on memory.

- At least 2 direct competitors (same job, similar method) and at least 2 indirect competitors (same problem, different method). Label each one "Direct" or "Indirect" under its name.
- Only pick apps that have a live store page in the store above and have been updated in the last 2 years.
- Prefer apps with enough written reviews to judge complaints. If you swap out an app I named or one from my spec, tell me which one and why.

TABLE

One table with these columns, in this order:

1. App and link: the name, Direct/Indirect, and an "Open in **[store]**" link. The whole cell should be clickable. Use only store URLs you have opened or seen in search results, never guessed ones.
2. Price: what's free, and what the paid plan costs per month and per year. Include one-time or lifetime prices. If the price is hidden, varies, or the store page contradicts itself, say so.
3. What it does well: 2–3 short sentences, with rating and rating count.
4. What it misses: 2–3 short sentences based on real user reviews and complaints. If there are no reviews, write "user complaints: not found."
5. What this means for our app: 2 short sentences on what to copy, avoid, or do differently.

WRITING RULES

- Everyday words a high school student would understand. Explain any unavoidable term in a few words.
- Short cells, no bullet points inside cells.
- Real numbers where you have them (ratings, rating counts, downloads, prices). Don't invent links or numbers. If you can't confirm something, write "not found."
- Mark numbers from third-party tracking sites as estimates.

LAYOUT

- Landscape letter-size PDF.
- At the top: the date, which store the numbers come from, a 2–3 sentence summary of my app, and a short "Words to know" line (direct, indirect, plus any other terms the table uses).
- Below the table: 3 bullet points on the biggest opportunities for my app, then a Sources list with a clickable link for every fact.
- Check the finished PDF: every link opens, nothing is cut off, and no heading is stranded at the bottom of a page.

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STEP 1B: SAVE INTO PROJECT

Save this into the project as a PDF called "Competitor Analysis".

STAGE 2 | TEST

Usability Test Plan

Plan a short test where real people try your mock app while you watch.

STEP 2: USABILITY TEST PLAN (YOUR HTML MOCK APP MUST BE IN THE PROJECT FOLDER)

Review the HTML mock app in the folder.

My testers are: **[WHO WILL TEST IT, e.g., adults over 60 who use a smartphone]**

Then make a usability test plan as a PDF I can download and print. Keep it to 2 pages. Use plain words a beginner can follow, and simple black-and-white formatting.

Include:

1. Test goal: 1–2 sentences on what we want to learn.
2. Who should test it: who to invite, plus simple setup steps for the mock (where to open it, how to reset it between testers).
3. Scenario: a short real-life situation written to the tester as "You...". Don't use the app's screen or button names.
4. Tasks: 4 numbered tasks the mock can do. For each one, list:
   - What to ask the tester (no hints about where to click)
   - What counts as success
   - What to watch for
5. After-test questions: 4 short, open-ended questions.
6. A blank Feedback Log table on its own page with these columns: Task #, Completed (Y/N/Partial), Time, Where they got stuck, Tester quotes.

Only include tasks the mock can do. If anything is unclear, ask me before you start.

Before you run the test

☐ Print one Feedback Log page per tester.

☐ Open the mock and click through every task yourself first. If a task breaks, fix the mock or drop the task.

☐ While they test, stay quiet. Write down what they say and where they pause instead of helping.

FINISHED EARLY?

Stretch Goals

☐ Ask Claude to turn the "What this means for our app" column into changes to your spec.

☐ Run the test with 3 people, then paste your Feedback Logs into Claude and ask which problems showed up more than once.

☐ Update your HTML mock to fix the biggest problem, and test it again with someone new.

Tips that apply to every stage

☐ Open every link in the Competitor Analysis yourself. If a link is wrong or a number looks off, tell Claude which one.

☐ Prices and ratings change. Put the date on anything you share.

☐ Pick testers who match the people your app is for, not friends who already know the idea.

☐ Claude can be wrong. If something doesn't work, it isn't your fault. Report what happened and try the fix.